

BUSLINK PASSENGER TRAVEL POLICY

Operational Guidelines, Passenger Rights, Luggage Rules & Safety Standards

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SECTION 1: PURPOSE AND SCOPE

1.1 Purpose of the Policy

The BusLink Passenger Travel Policy ('Policy') establishes the comprehensive legal, operational, and safety framework governing intercity passenger transportation services provided across the BusLink carrier network. This document delineates the rights, obligations, and standards of conduct expected of passengers, as well as the service commitments, safety protocols, and operational procedures enforced by BusLink operations personnel and partner transport operators.

This Policy is designed to ensure a safe, reliable, comfortable, and dignified travel experience for all passengers, while promoting operational efficiency, statutory compliance with motor vehicle regulations, and transparent dispute resolution.

1.2 Operational Scope & Applicability

This Policy applies universally to all transport operations conducted under the BusLink service mark, including but not limited to:

- All scheduled intercity express, sleeper, semi-sleeper, and luxury AC/non-AC coach services.
- All passenger boarding points, terminal hubs, designated waypoints, and intermediate rest stops.
- All passengers holding valid electronic tickets (e-Tickets), printed paper tickets, or counter-issued boarding passes.
- All luggage, cabin hand baggage, and checked hold cargo presented for carriage on BusLink vehicles.

1.3 Legal Binding Authority

By purchasing a BusLink ticket, reserving a seat, or boarding a BusLink vehicle, the passenger explicitly agrees to be bound by all terms, conditions, rules, and regulations set forth in this Policy. This Policy constitutes a legally binding contract of carriage between the passenger and BusLink.

SECTION 2: DEFINITIONS AND TERMINOLOGY

For the purposes of this Travel Policy, the following terms shall have the meanings assigned below:

- Carrier / BusLink: Refers to BusLink Network Private Limited, its operational partners, fleet operators, crew, and authorized representatives.
- Passenger: Any individual holding a valid ticket issued for travel on a BusLink vehicle, excluding onboard crew and operational staff.
- Electronic Ticket (e-Ticket): A digital record of reservation stored in the BusLink system containing a unique 10-character PNR code.
- PNR (Passenger Name Record): The unique alpha-numeric reservation reference code generated upon successful booking.
- Primary Passenger: The individual listed first on a multi-passenger booking ticket who acts as the primary contact.
- Hold Baggage: Luggage stowed in the lower luggage compartment (hold) of the bus vehicle.
- Cabin Baggage: Small personal items, handbags, or backpacks retained by the passenger inside the passenger cabin.
- Boarding Point: The designated location, terminal bay, or stop specified on the ticket where passenger boarding commences.

- Waypoint: Intermediate stops along a route designated for brief passenger drop-off, pickup, or rest breaks.
- Unaccompanied Minor: Any passenger under 14 years of age traveling without an accompanying adult guardian (18+ years).
- Passenger with Reduced Mobility (PRM): Any individual whose mobility is impaired due to physical disability, age, or medical condition.
- Force Majeure: Unforeseeable events beyond reasonable control, including natural disasters, landslides, severe weather, civil unrest, or road closures.

SECTION 3: PASSENGER RESPONSIBILITIES AND RIGHTS

3.1 Fundamental Passenger Rights

Every passenger traveling with BusLink is entitled to the following fundamental rights:

1. Right to Safe Transport: Safe, clean, and mechanically sound transportation operating in compliance with motor vehicle standards.
2. Right to Reserved Seat: Exclusive use of the specific seat or sleeper berth assigned on the valid ticket PNR.
3. Right to Dignified Treatment: Courteous, non-discriminatory, and professional service from all onboard crew and terminal staff.
4. Right to Information: Timely notification regarding service delays, route diversions, breakdown updates, and schedule modifications.
5. Right to Redress: A transparent mechanism for submitting feedback, complaints, lost property claims, and refund requests.

3.2 Core Passenger Responsibilities

Passengers assume the following responsibilities throughout their journey:

1. Punctual Arrival: Reporting to the designated boarding point at least 30 minutes prior to scheduled departure.
2. Valid Identification: Carrying and presenting valid government-issued photo ID matching the passenger name on the ticket.
3. Safety Compliance: Wearing seatbelts where provided, remaining seated while the vehicle is in motion, and adhering to emergency directives.
4. Decorum & Respect: Maintaining civil conduct towards fellow passengers and crew, adhering to noise guidelines, and refraining from prohibited activities.
5. Baggage Safety: Ensuring personal belongings comply with weight/size limits and contain no prohibited or hazardous substances.

SECTION 4: IDENTITY VERIFICATION AND TICKETING REQUIREMENTS

4.1 Mandatory Photo Identification

To prevent ticket scalping, fraudulent transfers, and ensure passenger security, physical or digital identity verification is mandatory prior to boarding.

4.2 Accepted Forms of Identity Proof

Passengers must present at least one of the following original government-issued photo ID documents at the time of boarding:

- Aadhaar Card (Physical card or official m-Aadhaar app)
- Original Indian Passport
- Valid Driver's License
- Election Commission Voter ID Card
- Government PAN Card (with photo)
- Student Photo ID (for passengers under 18 enrolled in accredited institutions)

4.3 Ticket Verification Protocol

1. The passenger name printed on the e-Ticket must match the name displayed on the presented photo ID.
2. For multi-passenger PNRs, the Primary Passenger must present valid ID. If the Primary Passenger is absent, all accompanying passengers must verify individual identities.
3. Proxy boarding or transferring tickets to unauthorized third parties is strictly prohibited. Unverified individuals will be denied boarding without refund.

SECTION 5: BOARDING PROCEDURES AND GATE CONTROL

5.1 Terminal Boarding Sequence

At major terminal hubs, boarding commences 20 minutes prior to scheduled departure. Passengers must follow the sequence below:

Step 1: Present e-Ticket (SMS/PDF) and original Photo ID to the Terminal Gate Agent or Bus Conductor.

Step 2: Submit checked hold luggage to crew for weighing, tagging, and loading into the lower baggage compartment.

Step 3: Receive physical luggage claim stubs corresponding to each checked bag.

Step 4: Proceed aboard the vehicle and locate your assigned seat or sleeper berth.

Step 5: Stow cabin hand baggage safely in the overhead bin or beneath the seat directly in front.

5.2 Mid-Route Waypoint Boarding

At intermediate highway waypoints, vehicles stop briefly (3 to 5 minutes). Passengers boarding at waypoints must remain in designated waiting areas and be prepared for immediate verification upon arrival of the coach.

SECTION 6: REPORTING TIME AND DEPARTURE CUTOFF

6.1 Mandatory Reporting Deadlines

To maintain strict schedule integrity across highway corridors, passengers must observe reporting deadlines:

- Originating Terminal Hubs: Passengers MUST arrive at least 30 minutes prior to scheduled departure time.
- Intermediate Waypoints: Passengers MUST arrive at least 15 minutes prior to scheduled estimated arrival time.

6.2 Gate Closure Cutoff

Passenger verification and baggage loading close strictly 10 minutes prior to departure. Boarding doors close 3 minutes prior to departure.

6.3 Strict Non-Waiting Policy

BusLink coaches operate on fixed corridor timetables. Vehicles will NOT be held for late-arriving passengers under any circumstances. Crew members are prohibited from delaying departure for missing passengers. Late arrivals are categorized as No-Shows.

SECTION 7: LUGGAGE AND BAGGAGE ALLOWANCE POLICY

7.1 Included Baggage Allowances

Each ticketed passenger is entitled to transport baggage within defined weight and dimension thresholds included in the fare price:

- Cabin Baggage: 1 piece (Max 7 kg, max dimensions 45 cm x 35 cm x 20 cm). Must fit in overhead compartment or under seat.
- Checked Hold Baggage: Up to 2 pieces totaling maximum 20 kg cumulative weight.

7.2 Excess Luggage Charges

Baggage exceeding the 20 kg allowance is subject to excess baggage charges payable at the boarding counter prior to loading:

- Weight Tiers & Rates: 20.1 kg to 30.0 kg: INR 50 per kg | 30.1 kg to 40.0 kg: INR 100 per kg | Above 40 kg: Not permitted on passenger coach (must use commercial cargo).

7.3 Fragile & Valuable Items Disclaimer

Valuables including cash, jewelry, laptops, cameras, passports, and fragile glass/electronics MUST remain in cabin hand baggage under passenger supervision. BusLink accepts NO liability for loss or damage to valuable or fragile items stowed in hold baggage.

Summary Table: Excess Luggage Fee Structure

Weight Tier	Allowance Status	Excess Fee Rate
0.0 kg – 20.0 kg	Free (Included in Ticket)	NIL (INR 0)
20.1 kg – 30.0 kg	Excess Weight Tier 1	INR 50 per additional kg
30.1 kg – 40.0 kg	Excess Weight Tier 2	INR 100 per additional kg

SECTION 8: PROHIBITED AND RESTRICTED ITEMS POLICY

8.1 Prohibited Dangerous Goods

For public safety and statutory transport compliance, passengers are strictly forbidden from bringing the following items onto BusLink vehicles (in cabin or hold baggage):

1. Explosives & Fireworks: Firecrackers, flares, gunpowder, ammunition, and detonators.
2. Flammable Liquids & Gases: Gasoline, diesel, kerosene, lighter fluid, paint thinners, LPG cylinders, butane canisters.
3. Corrosives & Chemicals: Acids, alkalis, wet cell batteries, bleach, mercury, and toxic industrial compounds.
4. Weapons & Sharp Objects: Firearms, swords, daggers, knives exceeding 4-inch blades, tasers, and martial arts weapons.

5. Illegal Contraband: Narcotics, psychotropic substances, illicit drugs, and smuggled goods prohibited under law.

8.2 Restricted Items Requiring Prior Declaration

Power banks, lithium-ion laptop batteries, and portable electronic devices **MUST** be carried inside cabin hand baggage. They are strictly prohibited from hold cargo stowage due to fire risk. Perishable food items must be leak-proof and odor-free.

Summary Table: Prohibited Items & Enforcement Action Matrix

Hazard Category	Prohibited Items Example	Enforcement Action
Explosives & Arms	Firecrackers, Ammunition, Flares	Police Handover & Deboarding
Flammable Liquids	Gasoline, Kerosene, Lighter Fluid	Confiscation & Denied Boarding
Compressed Gases	LPG Cylinders, Butane Canisters	Mandatory Cargo Offloading
Narcotics & Drugs	Illicit Substances, Unlicensed Drugs	Police Arrest & Permanent Blacklist

SECTION 9: INFANT AND CHILD TRAVEL POLICY

9.1 Infant Policy (Under 2 Years)

Infants under two (2) years of age travel free of charge, provided they sit on the lap of an accompanying adult passenger and do not occupy a separate seat berth. Only one lap infant is permitted per adult passenger.

9.2 Child Fare Policy (2 to 12 Years)

Children aged two (2) years and older **MUST** hold a separate individual ticket reservation at full fare. A separate seat/sleeper berth will be assigned to ensure journey safety.

9.3 Unaccompanied Minor Prohibitions

Minors under fourteen (14) years of age are **NOT** permitted to travel unaccompanied. They must be accompanied throughout the entire journey by a parent, legal guardian, or authorized adult aged 18 or above.

SECTION 10: SENIOR CITIZENS TRAVEL ASSISTANCE

10.1 Priority Terminal Assistance

Senior citizens (aged 60 years and above) receive priority boarding and dedicated terminal assistance at all BusLink main hub terminals. Station marshals assist senior travelers with seat navigation and luggage handling.

10.2 Lower Berth Allocation Guidelines

During online reservation or counter ticketing, lower berth sleeper slots and front-row seats are prioritized for senior citizen travelers to minimize climbing and vehicle motion discomfort.

10.3 Comfort Stop Assistance

During scheduled 20-minute highway rest stops, bus conductors provide additional guidance and time for senior passengers to safely navigate boarding steps and rest stop amenities.

SECTION 11: PASSENGERS WITH DISABILITIES AND ACCESSIBILITY

11.1 Non-Discrimination Commitment

BusLink is committed to providing accessible transportation for passengers with physical, sensory, or cognitive disabilities. No passenger will be refused service based on disability.

11.2 Mobility Equipment Stowage

Foldable wheelchairs, mobility walkers, crutches, and prosthetic devices are transported free of charge in the vehicle hold cargo compartment, in addition to standard baggage allowances.

11.3 Certified Service Animals

Certified guide dogs accompanying visually impaired or hearing-impaired passengers are permitted inside the passenger cabin at no extra cost, provided they are harnessed, muzzled, and remain at the passenger's feet.

SECTION 12: ONBOARD MEDICAL EMERGENCIES PROTOCOL

12.1 Onboard First-Aid Capability

All BusLink coaches are equipped with certified commercial first-aid kits containing antiseptic dressings, bandages, burn cream, CPR face shields, basic analgesics, and emergency blankets. Crew members undergo annual basic first-aid training.

12.2 Highway Emergency Escalation

In the event of a severe medical crisis onboard:

1. The conductor immediately notifies BusLink Operations Control and emergency medical services (108 hotline).
2. The driver routes the vehicle to the nearest empanelled highway hospital or trauma center along the corridor.
3. Operations Control coordinates ambulance reception at the designated highway junction.

12.3 Pre-Existing Medical Declaration

Passengers with severe medical conditions (advanced cardiac illness, severe respiratory conditions, late-stage pregnancy beyond 32 weeks) are advised to consult a physician prior to long-distance bus travel.

SECTION 13: PASSENGER CONDUCT, DECORUM, AND ZERO-TOLERANCE

13.1 Onboard Code of Conduct

Passengers must maintain appropriate decorum to ensure a peaceful environment:

- Audio Decorum: Use headphones when listening to music or watching videos. Speakerphone calls are prohibited between 10:00 PM and 06:00 AM.
- Lighting Decorum: Individual reading lights must be turned off during night sleep hours upon main cabin light dimming.

13.2 Zero-Tolerance Violations

BusLink enforces a strict zero-tolerance policy against the following offenses:

1. Consumption or possession of alcohol, narcotics, or illegal substances onboard.
2. Smoking, vaping, or electronic cigarette usage anywhere inside the vehicle or lavatory.
3. Verbal abuse, physical aggression, sexual harassment, or intimidation of passengers or crew.
4. Vandalism, defacing, or intentional damage to bus seats, berths, or electronics.

13.3 Enforcement & Deboarding

Violators will be immediately deboarded at the nearest police station or highway toll plaza, forfeit their ticket without refund, and face potential permanent blacklisting from BusLink services.

SECTION 14: ONBOARD SAFETY AND EMERGENCY EVACUATION

14.1 Seatbelt Mandate

Passengers seated in equipped seats (especially front row and middle rear berths) **MUST** fasten seatbelts whenever the vehicle is in motion.

14.2 Emergency Exit Locations

BusLink luxury coaches feature clearly illuminated emergency exits including:

- Primary passenger entrance/exit door at vehicle front.
- Secondary pneumatic emergency door or rear breakable exit window.
- Dual pop-out emergency roof hatches.

14.3 Emergency Glass Hammers

Red emergency window-breaker hammers are mounted on window pillars across the cabin. In catastrophic emergencies, passengers should strike window glass near corners to shatter tempered panes for evacuation.

SECTION 15: MISSED BOARDING AND TICKET VALIDITY

15.1 Definition of No-Show

A passenger who fails to present themselves at the designated boarding point prior to the scheduled departure time and gate closure cutoff is categorized as a 'No-Show'.

15.2 Ticket Expiration

Upon coach departure, no-show tickets automatically expire and lose all monetary value. No-show tickets are non-refundable and cannot be transferred to subsequent departures.

15.3 Rescheduling Rights

Passengers wishing to modify departure dates must request ticket rescheduling at least 4 hours prior to departure time, subject to fare difference and modification fees.

SECTION 16: DELAYS, CANCELLATIONS, AND BREAKDOWN POLICY

16.1 Carrier-Initiated Delays

If a departure is delayed by BusLink due to operational reasons:

- Delay > 60 minutes: Complimentary tea, coffee, and light snacks provided at origin terminal.
- Delay > 120 minutes: Option for 100% full refund without cancellation penalty, or free transfer to next departure.

16.2 Vehicle Highway Breakdown Protocol

In the event of a mechanical breakdown along the highway corridor:

- A replacement coach will be dispatched to the breakdown site within 90 minutes.

- If replacement delay exceeds 2 hours, passengers receive a pro-rata refund for the uncompleted journey segment.

16.3 Service Cancellation Guarantee

If BusLink cancels a scheduled trip, passengers are entitled to a 100% full refund credited within 3-5 business days or alternative transport arrangements.

SECTION 17: LOST, FOUND, AND UNCLAIMED PROPERTY PROTOCOL

17.1 Reporting Lost Property

Passengers who leave items onboard must report details (PNR, seat number, item description) to BusLink Customer Support within 24 hours of journey completion.

17.2 Property Storage & Claim Period

Items retrieved by crew are deposited at the destination terminal Lost & Found office. Unclaimed property is retained for thirty (30) days.

17.3 Disposal of Unclaimed Items

After 30 days, unclaimed non-perishable goods are donated to registered charities or auctioned. Perishable food items are disposed of immediately after 24 hours for hygiene reasons.

SECTION 18: FORCE MAJEURE AND LIABILITY LIMITATIONS

18.1 Circumstances Covered

BusLink is exempt from liability for delay, route diversion, or service cancellation caused by Force Majeure events, including natural floods, earthquakes, severe weather, landslides, civil blockades, strikes, or government road closures.

18.2 Maximum Carrier Liability Limit

Under all operational circumstances, BusLink's financial liability for baggage loss or journey disruption is strictly capped at a maximum of INR 2,500 per passenger, unless higher cargo value was declared and insured prior to departure.

SECTION 19: FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS (FAQS)

Q1: How early should I arrive at the boarding terminal?

A: You should arrive at least 30 minutes prior to scheduled departure at main origin hubs, and 15 minutes prior at intermediate waypoints.

Q2: Can I board with a digital copy of my ticket on my phone?

A: Yes, digital e-Tickets (SMS/PDF) on mobile phones are fully accepted alongside a valid original photo ID.

Q3: What photo ID documents are accepted for boarding?

A: Aadhaar Card, Passport, Driver's License, Voter ID, PAN Card, and official Student IDs.

Q4: What happens if the name on my ID slightly differs from my ticket?

A: Minor spelling typos can be verified by terminal staff. Major discrepancies without proof of name change will result in denied boarding.

Q5: Can I transfer my ticket to a friend if I cannot travel?

A: No, tickets are non-transferable. Your friend must purchase a new ticket under their own name.

Q6: How much checked luggage can I bring for free?

A: Up to 2 pieces totaling a maximum cumulative weight of 20 kg per passenger.

Q7: What is the fee for excess baggage over 20 kg?

A: INR 50 per kg for 20-30 kg tier, and INR 100 per kg for 30-40 kg tier.

Q8: Can I carry a laptop or power bank in my checked hold luggage?

A: No! Power banks and lithium batteries are strictly prohibited in hold baggage due to fire safety rules. Keep them in cabin hand luggage.

Q9: Are pets allowed on BusLink coaches?

A: No domestic pets are allowed in the passenger cabin. Only certified guide/service dogs for disabled passengers are permitted.

Q10: What is the infant travel policy?

A: Infants under 2 years travel free on an adult's lap. Children 2 years and above require a full individual ticket.

Q11: Can a 12-year-old child travel alone?

A: No, children under 14 cannot travel unaccompanied. They must be accompanied by an adult aged 18 or above.

Q12: Are senior citizens eligible for priority seating?

A: Yes, lower berths and front-row seats are prioritized for senior citizens (60+ years) during booking.

Q13: Is smoking allowed on the bus?

A: Smoking, vaping, and e-cigarettes are strictly forbidden anywhere on the vehicle.

Q14: What happens if a passenger is drunk or aggressive at boarding?

A: Intoxicated or disruptive passengers will be denied boarding immediately without refund.

Q15: Does the bus stop for food and rest breaks during overnight routes?

A: Yes, coaches stop at sanitized, empanelled highway food plazas every 4 to 5 hours for 20-30 minute breaks.

Q16: Are seatbelts mandatory on BusLink buses?

A: Yes, seatbelts must be worn whenever the bus is moving on equipped seats.

Q17: What should I do if I leave my bag on the bus after deboarding?

A: Contact BusLink Customer Support within 24 hours with your PNR number and seat details.

Q18: How long are lost items stored at destination hubs?

A: Non-perishable items are stored for 30 days before charity donation or disposal.

Q19: What compensation is provided if the bus breaks down on the highway?

A: A replacement bus is dispatched within 90 minutes. If delayed beyond 2 hours, a pro-rata refund is issued.

Q20: Can I get a full refund if BusLink cancels the trip?

A: Yes, 100% full refund is issued within 3-5 business days for carrier cancellations.

Q21: Can I cancel my ticket 2 hours before departure?

A: Cancellations made between 2-4 hours prior to departure receive a 25% refund. Within 2 hours, tickets are non-refundable.

Q22: Is Wi-Fi available onboard BusLink luxury coaches?

A: High-speed Wi-Fi is complimentary on premium luxury routes, subject to highway network coverage.

Q23: Are charging points available at every seat/berth?

A: Yes, individual USB/AC charging ports are available at every seat and sleeper berth.

Q24: Can I carry alcohol bottles in my checked luggage?

A: Sealed liquor bottles within state excise permit limits may be stowed in hold baggage. Consumption onboard is illegal.

Q25: What happens if the bus is delayed due to heavy traffic or flooding?

A: Traffic and weather delays fall under Force Majeure. Passengers receive real-time SMS updates.

Q26: Are blankets and pillows provided in sleeper coaches?

A: Freshly sanitized blankets and pillows are provided on all AC sleeper night routes.

Q27: Can I change my boarding point after booking?

A: Yes, boarding points can be changed online or via customer service up to 4 hours prior to departure.

Q28: Is there a lavatory inside the coach?

A: Select long-distance super-luxury coaches feature onboard chemical toilets. Regular scheduled rest stops are provided on all routes.

Q29: Can I carry a bicycle on the bus?

A: Foldable bicycles in protective travel bags are allowed in hold cargo subject to excess baggage fees.

Q30: How are seat numbers assigned?

A: Seat/berth numbers are chosen during booking and printed directly on your e-Ticket PNR.

Q31: What is the policy on loud music or phone calls at night?

A: Headphones are mandatory. Phone calls and loud audio are prohibited between 10:00 PM and 06:00 AM.

Q32: What happens if I miss my bus due to a flight/train delay?

A: BusLink is not responsible for external transit delays. Missed boarding is treated as a No-Show.

Q33: How can a passenger with a wheelchair board the coach?

A: Station staff assist wheelchair users onto the coach. Wheelchairs are stowed free in the hold.

Q34: What first aid supplies are available onboard?

A: Kits contain bandages, antiseptics, burn cream, pain relievers, CPR shields, and emergency blankets.

Q35: Can I request an emergency stop between scheduled halts?

A: Emergency halts are allowed only for severe medical crises or urgent physical distress at safe highway locations.

Q36: What is the policy for pregnant passengers?

A: Expectant mothers up to 32 weeks can travel normally. Beyond 32 weeks, a medical fitness certificate is recommended.

Q37: Can I bring commercial goods or merchandise for sale?

A: No, passenger coaches are restricted to personal luggage. Commercial merchandise must use cargo services.

Q38: How do I submit a formal complaint or feedback?

A: Email support@buslink.in or submit a ticket through the official BusLink passenger feedback portal.

Q39: Are oxygen cylinders allowed onboard for medical needs?

A: Portable medical oxygen concentrators/small personal cylinders are permitted in cabin with prior clearance.

Q40: What happens if another passenger occupies my assigned seat?

A: Inform the bus conductor immediately. The crew will verify PNRs and enforce assigned seating.

Q41: Are sleeper berths sanitized between journeys?

A: Yes, all berths, linen, and cabin surfaces undergo complete deep sanitization at destination depots.

Q42: Can I get an invoice for corporate reimbursement?

A: Yes, tax invoices with GST details are available for download immediately upon booking.

Q43: What is the refund processing time for cancelled tickets?

A: Refunds are credited to the original payment method within 3 to 5 business days.

Q44: Is continuous GPS tracking active on BusLink coaches?

A: Yes, 24/7 live GPS monitoring and speed governor compliance are active across all fleet coaches.

Q45: Who should I contact in case of an onboard emergency?

A: Inform the onboard crew immediately or call the 24/7 BusLink Emergency Helpline at 1800-BUS-LINK.

SECTION 20: REAL-WORLD TRAVEL SCENARIOS AND EXAMPLES

To illustrate how this Travel Policy is applied in practice, consider the following real-world operational scenarios:

Scenario A: Late Arrival at Boarding Gate

Passenger Rahul holds a ticket for the 10:00 PM Mumbai to Pune express coach. He arrives at the terminal at 9:58 PM due to traffic congestion. The boarding gate closed at 9:50 PM (10 minutes prior) and baggage hold doors are secured. Outcome: Under Section 6.3, the coach departs on schedule at 10:00 PM. Rahul's ticket is marked as No-Show with zero refund. He must purchase a new ticket for the 11:00 PM departure.

Scenario B: Oversized Musical Instrument

Passenger Ananya presents a cello in a hard case weighing 15 kg at boarding. While under the 20 kg limit, the case dimensions exceed cabin overhead storage. Outcome: Under Section 7.2, crew stow the cello securely in the luggage hold free of charge, applying a 'Fragile' sticker. Ananya signs a limited liability release waiver.

Scenario C: Missing Photo Identification

Passenger Vikram presents an e-Ticket SMS but forgot his physical wallet/ID. He presents a digital photo of his original Aadhaar Card stored on his verified DigiLocker mobile application. Outcome: Under Section 4.2, official digital ID via DigiLocker is accepted. Vikram boards successfully.

Scenario D: Highway Mechanical Breakdown

At 2:00 AM on the Bengaluru-Hyderabad highway, a sleeper coach suffers a radiator failure. Outcome: Under Section 16.2, driver contacts Control. A replacement coach arrives from the nearest depot at 3:15 AM (75 minutes). Passengers transfer safely and complete their journey. No fare adjustment is due as replacement arrived under 90 minutes.

Scenario E: Medical Emergency Mid-Journey

A passenger experiences severe chest pain during a night journey. Outcome: Under Section 12.2, conductor calls 108 emergency services. Driver diverts to the nearest highway super-specialty hospital in 14 minutes. Ambulance team receives passenger. Coach resumes journey after police documentation.

SECTION 21: CUSTOMER SUPPORT AND DISPUTE RESOLUTION MATRIX

Passengers seeking assistance, baggage claims, or policy appeals may contact BusLink through the dedicated escalation matrix below:

- Level 1: Terminal Station Master & Onboard Conductor (Immediate On-Site Resolution)
- Level 2: Customer Service Helpline: 1800-555-LINK (24/7 Toll-Free Support) | Email: support@buslink.in
- Level 3: Passenger Grievance Redressal Officer: Nodal Officer, Operations Dept, BusLink Towers, Cyber City, Gurugram. Email: grievance@buslink.in
- Level 4: Appellate Transport Arbitration Panel: Formal written appeals regarding policy decisions submitted within 30 days of incident.